

Size and Portability

The HP sb21 was the smallest in terms of volume and weight. It weighed just 990 gm, making it the lightest of them all. It has a neat design and is user-friendly to boot. The heaviest was the BenQ PB2120 at 1.78 kg; the Panasonic PT-LM1E-C was larger, but weighed 1.6 kg.



Sharp XR-1S

How Did They Perform?

A mobile projector will primarily be used for marketing presentations and/or training at a client's end. In the presentation test, the Panasonic PT-LM1E-C and the BenQ PB2120 returned good overall scores. When we measured them over text quality, the Panasonic, HP and BenQ projectors returned good results with good background brightness and finely set contrasts. In the reverse-text test, Panasonic fared better than the rest with yellow, brown and radium green text on blue backgrounds being clearly visible.

The BenQ had problems with the yellow whereas Sharp XR-1S had issues with dark green.

Performance While Displaying Graphs

The next test was for graph quality where Panasonic again proved better than the rest. It displayed green and blue correctly, followed by BenQ and HP which were a little darker. Sharp missed out since sides of the 3D bar appeared black instead of the original colours.

Performance While Displaying Movies

The movie test was where Sharp unit finally left a positive mark—it showcased detailed scenes and better colour reproduction than the rest. The BenQ also put up a good show in movie mode, with nice skin tones both in daylight and good reproduction of detail in the dark scenes. HP and Panasonic projectors performed well but the night scene appeared a tad too dark with these units, which made the background lose details.

DisplayMate Video Edition

In the DisplayMate Video Edition test, where we look for sharpness, focusing and colour reproduction, BenQ was the clear winner. Horizontal and vertical bar resolution was perfect with no

moiré at all and the resolution matrix appeared lively and crisply focused. Panasonic also returned good results with very little out-of-focus problems. The HP sb21 disappointed in this test as the resolution matrix was out of focus at its corners.

The BenQ was again unbeatable when it came to differentiating between 16 shades of grey; it showed no ghosting or streaking at all. It also produced red, green and blue brilliantly. Sharp performed better here with no visible ghosting and good resolution of the grey shades. HP and Panasonic had problems differentiating between the 15th and the 16th shade of grey, which appeared as single dark block.

BenQ unit also displayed a perfectly dark screen, along with the Panasonic—no flicker either. Sharp's projector was close behind—its black was not quite black, though. HP returned a mediocre performance with visible flicker and the projected screen appearing a little brighter in the centre than at the corners.

Total Cost of Lamp

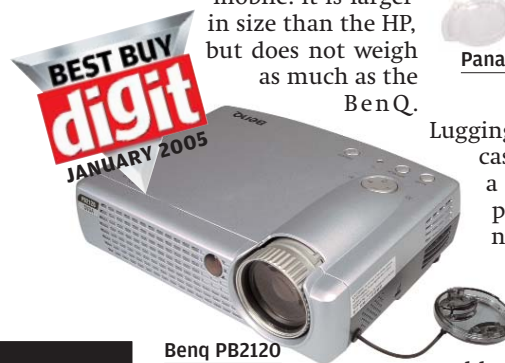
Sharp, with a lamp-life of 4,000 hours, costs Rs 5.5 per hour, making it the most affordable in terms of running cost. Panasonic, with Rs 6.25 per hour, was also good. HP's lamp, at Rs 16.60 per hour, was the costliest!

And The Winners Are...

The Panasonic PT-LM1E-C—an LCD projector—turned out to be an all-round performer. It returned good results in the presentation tests, with good colour reproduction and faithful animation. In the movie test, it returned watchable results. The Panasonic, though, is more portable than mobile: it is larger in size than the HP, but does not weigh as much as the BenQ.



Panasonic PT-LM1E-C



BenQ PB2120

Lugging it around in a case that can hold a laptop and a projector should not be an issue.

With a good set of features and commendable performance, Panasonic earned the Digit 'Best Buy' Gold award.

BenQ was the one that took the Digit 'Best Buy' silver. A few of its features, as well as its lamp cost, dragged it down to second place. If you are not too budget-sensitive, the BenQ will impress your audience with crisp slides in presentations and faithful movie rendition. ■

aliasgar_pardawala@thinkdigit.com

Contact Sheet

Brand	Company	Telephone	E-mail	Web site
Acer	Acer India Pvt Ltd	080-25219520	rajesh.aiyar@acer.co.in	www.acer.co.in
BenQ	BenQ India Pvt Ltd	022-25705230	SalesEnquiryIn@BenQ.com	www.benq.com
Canon	Canon India Ltd	0124-5160000	VP.Sajeewan@canon.co.in	www.canon.co.in
Epson	Epson India Pvt. Ltd	080-30515000	venkat@eid.epson.co.in	www.epson.co.in
HP	Hewlett Packard India Ltd	0124-2566111	saranya.rustagi@hp.com	www.hp.com
Infocus	Genesis IT Innovations Ltd.	080-51280666	sales@gitil.com	www.infocus.com
Panasonic	Panasonic India Pvt Ltd	0120-2567045	s.bhushan@npi.panasonic.co.in	www.nationalpanasonicindia.com
Sharp	Sharp India Pvt Ltd	011-26431313	anilsodhani@sharp-oa.com	www.sbsil.com
Sony	Sony India Ltd	022-28313333	chiragk@sid.in.sony.com.sg	www.sony.co.in
Toshiba	HCL Infinit Ltd	022-22832016	vrajput@hclsys.com	www.toshiba.com